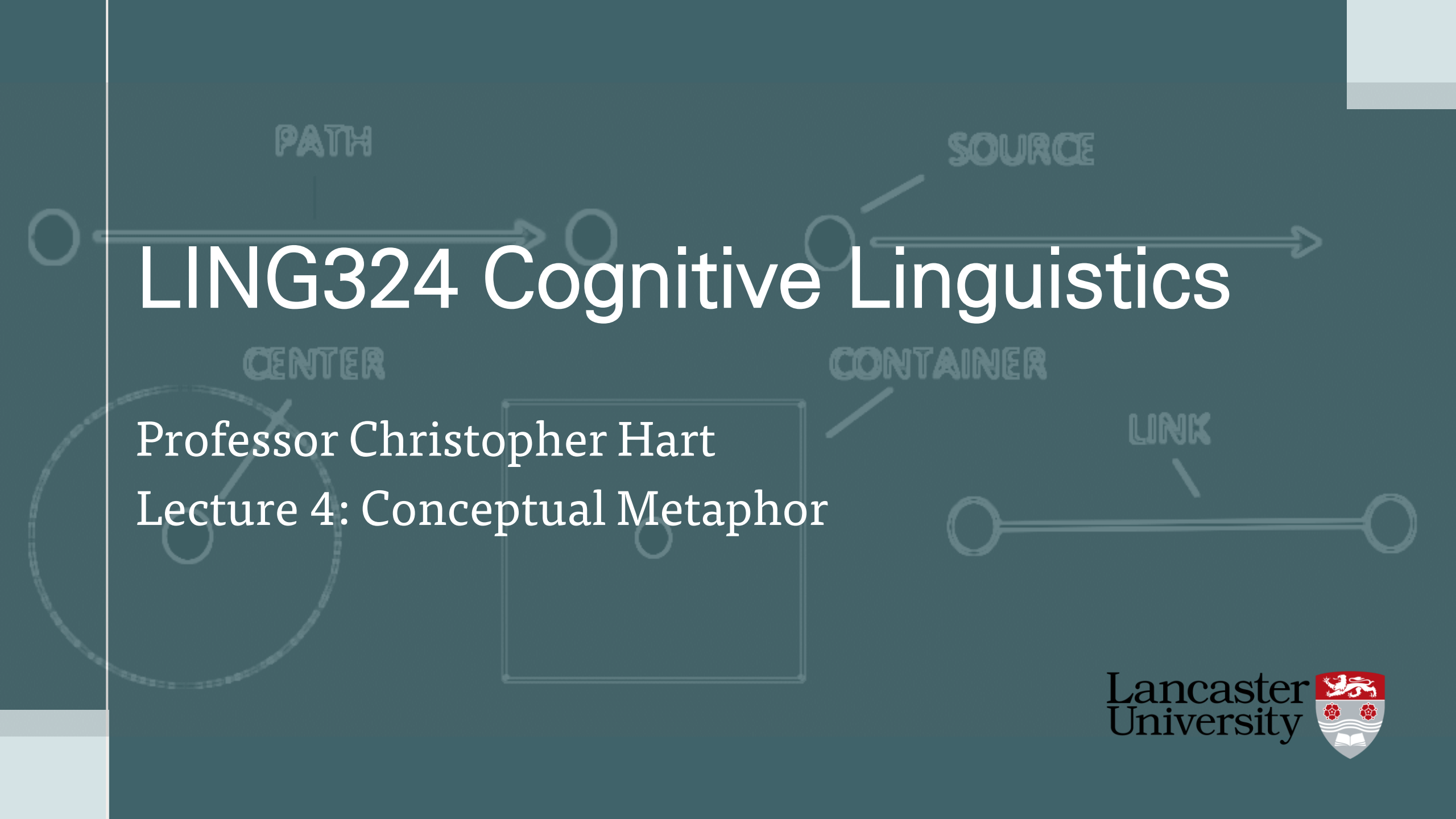




LING324 Cognitive Linguistics

Professor Christopher Hart
Lecture 4: Conceptual Metaphor

Overview

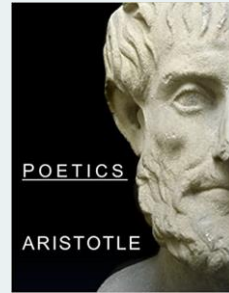
- Classical accounts
- Literal first hypothesis
- Conceptual metaphor theory
 - Domains and mappings
 - Relations and entailments
 - Invariance
 - Highlighting and hiding
- Experiential grounding
- Multimodal metaphor

Classical Accounts

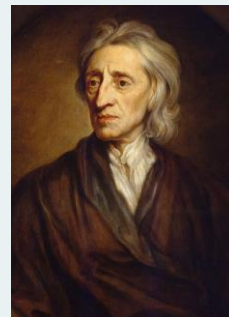
- Metaphor a matter of words
- Literary and rhetorical functions
- Emotion rather than reason
- Exceptional rather than ordinary

*"But soft, what light through
yonder window breaks? It is the
east, and Juliet is the sun!"*

(Romeo & Juliet, William Shakespeare)



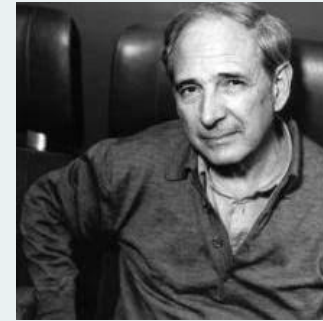
An application of an alien name by
transference (Aristotle, *Poetics*, ca. 350 BC)



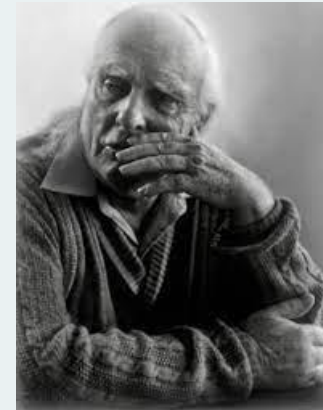
All the artificial and figurative applications of words
eloquence hath invented, are for nothing else than to
insinuate wrong ideas, move the passions, and
thereby mislead the judgement; and so indeed are
perfect cheats (Locke 1690: 508)

Literal First Hypothesis

- Addressee computes literal interpretation
- Rejects it on plausibility grounds
- Assumes speaker cooperating
- Subsequently searches for possible alternative meanings
- Settles on most likely intended meaning



John Searle



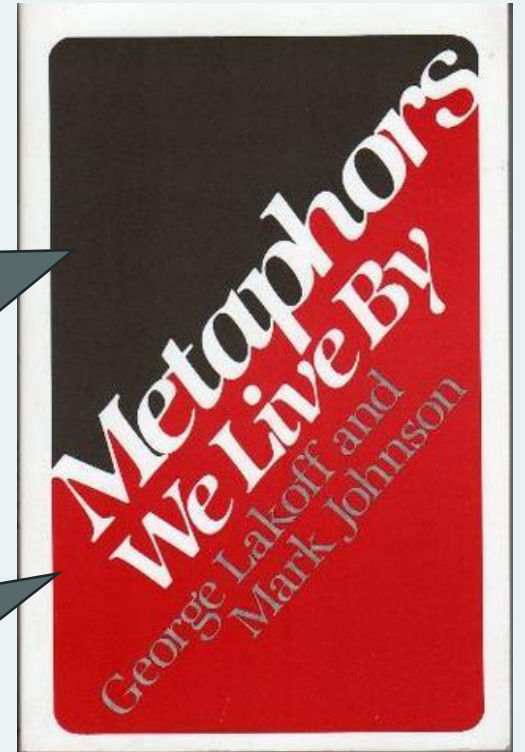
Paul Grice

Conceptual Metaphor Theory

- Metaphor a matter of thought (and action)
- Important reasoning device
- Reflected in 'everyday' language
- Highly conventionalised
- Conceptual metaphors accessed directly by metaphorical expressions
- Evidenced by **systematicity** found in metaphoric expressions
 - Not necessarily of X is Y form

metaphor is not just a matter of language, that is, of mere words ... [O]n the contrary, human *thought processes* are largely metaphorical ...
[T]he human conceptual system is metaphorically structured and defined. (Lakoff & Johnson 1980: 6)

the essence of metaphor is understanding and experiencing one thing in terms of another" (Lakoff and Johnson 1980: 5)



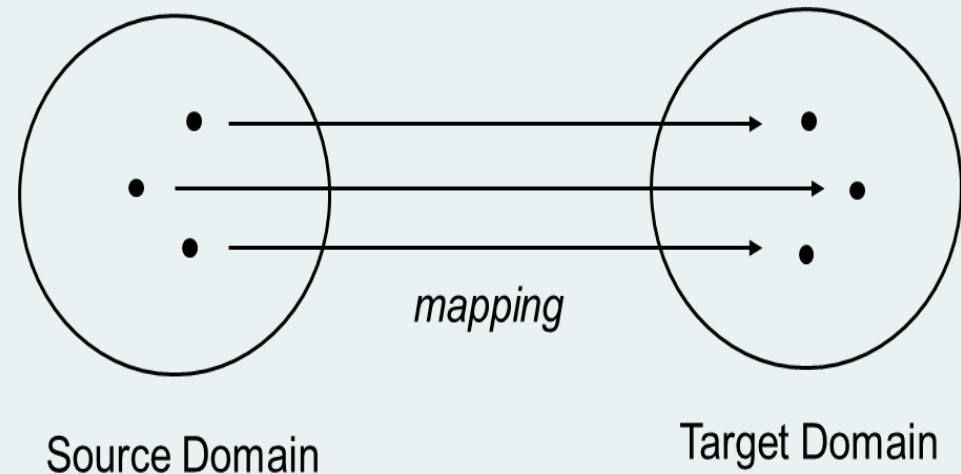
Conceptual Metaphor Theory

- a. Your claims are *indefensible*
- b. He *attacked* every weak point in my argument
- c. His criticisms were *right on target*
- d. I *demolished* his argument
- e. I've never *won* an argument with him
- f. You disagree? Okay, *shoot*!
- g. If you use that *strategy*, he'll *wipe you out*
- h. He *shot down* all of my arguments

(Lakoff and Johnson 1980: 4)

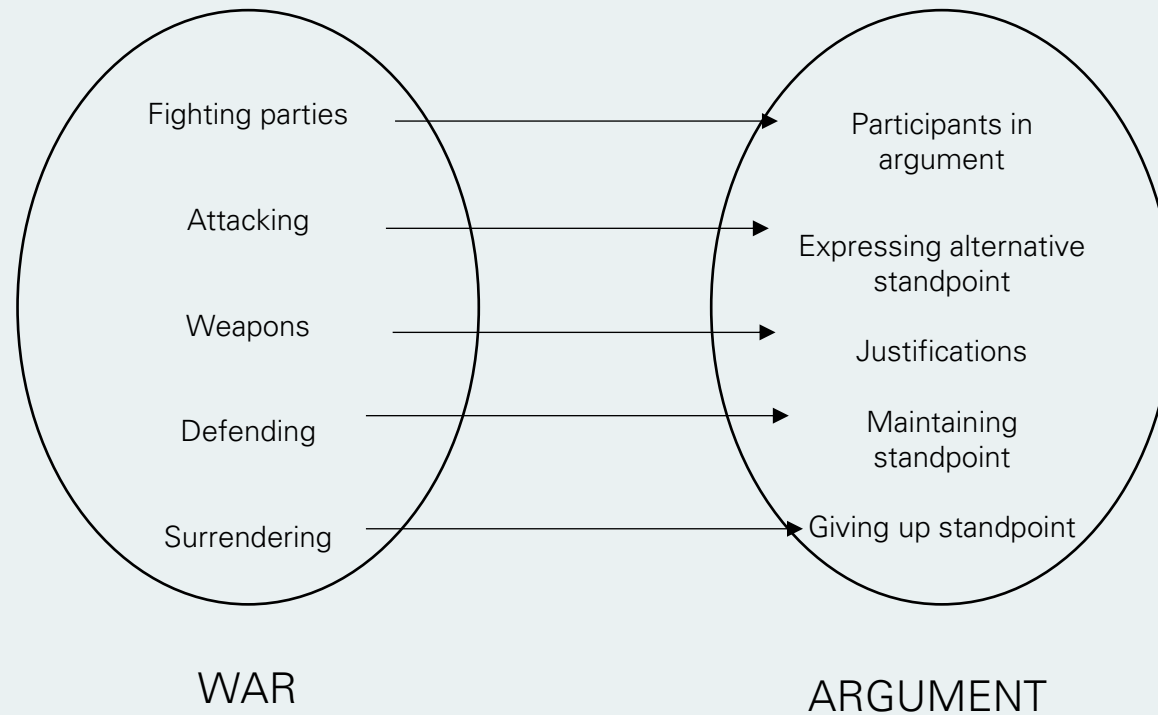
Domains and Mappings

- At cognitive level, metaphor involves **mapping** from elements in a **source domain** (SD) onto elements in a **target domain** (TD)
- TD inherits conceptual structure from SD
- SD provides template for thinking, feeling and acting with respect to TD
- Domains structured by **frames** and image **schemas**



Domains and Mappings

- ARGUMENT IS WAR



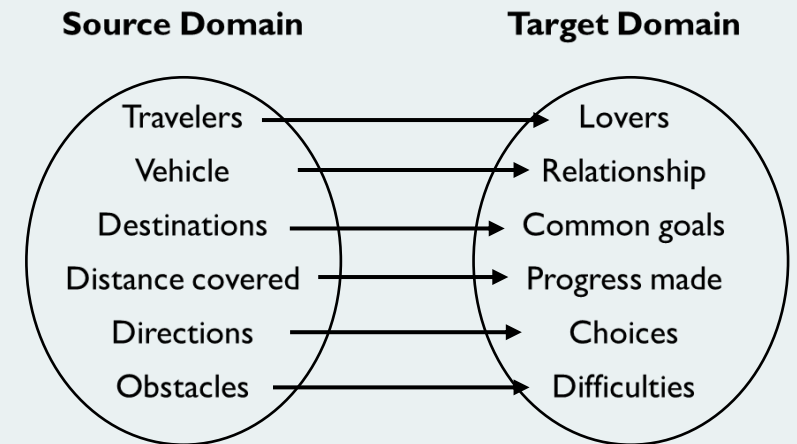
Domains and Mappings

- SDs concrete, familiar areas of experience:
 - E.g. HUMAN BODY, PLANTS, ANIMALS, FOOD, FORCES
- TDs more abstract and otherwise underspecified areas of experience
 - E.g. EMOTION, MORALITY, THOUGHT, RELATIONSHIPS, TIME
- Mappings **unidirectional**



Domains and Mappings

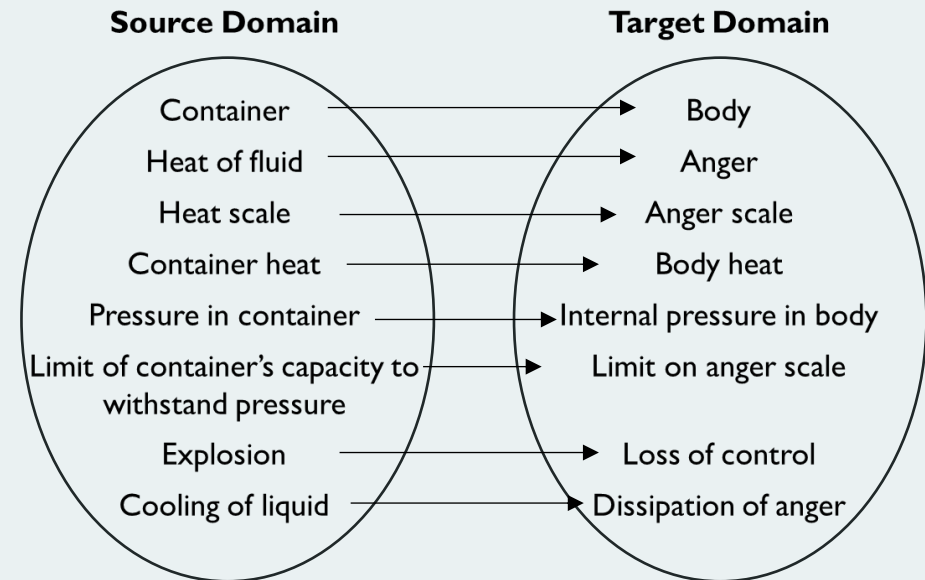
- a. Our relationship has *hit a dead end*
- b. We're going *through a rough patch*
- c. Look *how far we've come*
- d. We're at *a crossroads* in our relationship
- e. We may have to *go our separate ways*
- f. This relationship isn't *going anywhere*
- g. We're *spinning our wheels*
- h. Their marriage is *on the rocks*



(Lakoff 1993: 206-7)

Domains and Mappings

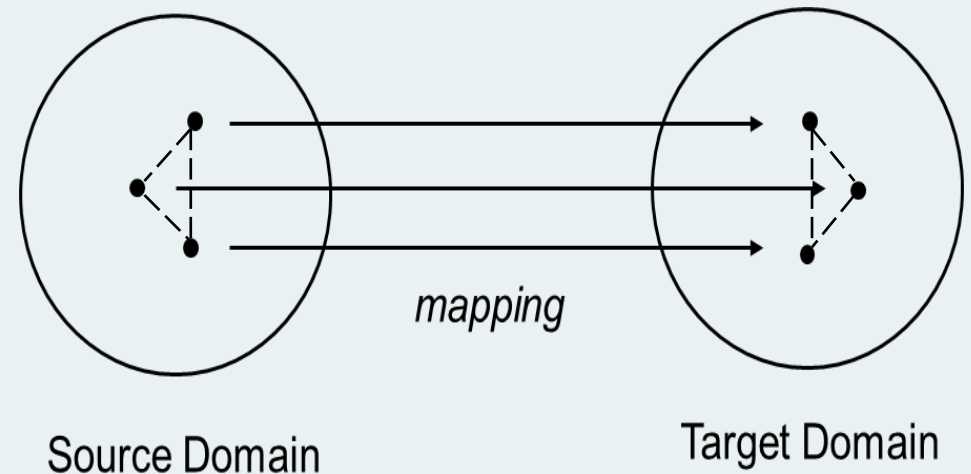
- a. That makes my *blood boil*
- b. I had reached *boiling point*
- c. *Simmer down!*
- d. Let him *stew* for a while
- e. I was *fuming*
- f. I felt the anger *rising* inside me
- g. I needed to *let off some steam*
- h. He *flipped his lid*
- i. I *hit the roof*
- j. He *bottled up* his anger for a long time



(Lakoff 1987: 387; see also Kövecses 2003)

Relations and Entailments

- **Ontological** relations
 - Held between corresponding elements in SD and TD
- **Epistemological** relations
 - Held between elements in SD
 - Transferred to corresponding elements in TD
- Produce **metaphoric entailments**
 - Implications and inferences arising from metaphoric mapping
 - E.g. If time is money, and money is a finite resource, then it follows that time is also a finite resource



Relations and Entailments

- You're *wasting* my time
- This gadget will *save* you hours
- I don't *have* the time to *give* you
- How do you *spend* you're time these days
- That flat tyre *cost* me an hour
- I don't have *enough* time to *spare* for that
- Is that *worth* your while?
- He's living on *borrowed* time

(Lakoff & Johnson 1980: 8)

Invariance

- Partial mapping; not all aspects of SD mapped
- Only aspects compatible with TD and in way consistent with organisation of TD
- **Invariance Principle** – “constraints on fixed correspondences” (Lakoff 1993: 215)
- Entailments incompatible with TD blocked – **TD Override**

Metaphorical mappings preserve the cognitive topology (that is, the image schema structure) of the source domain, in a way consistent with the inherent structure of the target domain. (Lakoff 1993: 215)

- a. Ivy gave Wilbur a book and he kept it
- b. Ivy gave Wilbur a minute and he kept it

Highlighting and Hiding

- Partial mapping leads to **highlighting** and **hiding** effects

“In allowing us to focus on one aspect of a concept (e.g. the battling aspects of arguing), a metaphorical concept can keep us from focusing on other aspects of the concept that are inconsistent with the metaphor
(Lakoff and Johnson 1980: 10)

- Framing power of metaphor in social domains (e.g. Thibodeau & Boroditsky 2011)



Experiential Grounding

- Motivation: **resemblance** vs **correlation** (Grady 1999)
- **Primary metaphors** (Grady 1997) emerge through correlations of subjective mental and sensorimotor experience
 - E.g. QUANTITY IS ELEVATION
 - Other **orientational** metaphors
- Link concepts that are equally basic or familiar where both directly perceived or experienced
- Foundational and atomic – building blocks of **compound** metaphors
 - E.g. EVENT STRUCTURE metaphor

Experiential Grounding

- QUANTITY IS SIZE/ELEVATION
 - My child has a *huge* amount of toys
 - Only a *tiny* number of people showed up
 - The price of shares is *going up*
 - Interest rates are *falling*
- Quantity and size/elevation correlated in everyday experience
- When quantity increases, so does mass and evaluation



Experiential Grounding

- **Orientational metaphors** organise whole system of concepts with respect to spatial schemas (e.g. UP/DOWN)

HAPPY IS UP; SAD IS DOWN

I'm feeling *up*. That *boosted* my spirits. My spirits *rose*. Thinking about her gives me a *lift*. I'm feeling *down*. He's really *low* these days. I *fell* into a depression. My spirits *sank*.

Physical basis: drooping posture typically accompanies sadness and depression while erect posture accompanies positive emotional states

CONSCIOUS IS UP; UNCONSCIOUS IS DOWN

He woke *up*. He *rises* early in the morning. He *fell* asleep. He *dropped* off to sleep. He's *under* hypnosis. He *sank* into a coma.

Physical basis: Humans and most other mammals sleep lying down and stand up when they awaken.

HEALTH AND LIFE ARE UP; SICKNESS AND DEATH ARE DOWN

He's at the *peak* of health. He's in *top* shape. He *fell* ill. He's *sinking* fast. He came *down* with the flu. His health is *declining*. He *dropped* dead.

Physical basis: Serious illness forces us to lie down. When you're dead you're physically down.

Experiential Grounding

AFFECTION IS WARMTH	Subjective judgement: Affection Sensorimotor domain: Temperature Example: They gave me a <i>warm</i> welcome Basis: Feeling warm while being held affectionately
INTIMACY IS CLOSENESS	Subjective judgement: Intimacy Sensorimotor domain: Proximity in space Example: We've been <i>close</i> for years but we're <i>drifting apart</i> Basis: Being physically close to people you're intimate with
SIMILARITY IS CLOSENESS	Subjective judgement: Similarity Sensorimotor domain: Proximity in space Example: They bear a <i>close</i> resemblance to one another Basis: Observing similar objects clustered together
CONTROL IS UP	Subjective judgement: Being in control Sensorimotor domain: Vertical orientation Example: I'm on top of the situation Basis: Easier to exert control over object from above
UNDERSTANDING IS GRASPING	Subjective judgement: Comprehension Sensorimotor domain: Object manipulation Example: I finally grasped the idea Basis: Obtaining information about an object by handling it

Experiential Grounding

- Event-Structure metaphor

- Complex metaphor comprising multiple primary metaphors
- Aspects of event-structure (STATES, CHANGES, PROCESSES, ACTIONS, CAUSES, PURPOSES, MEANS) conceptualised in terms of SPACE, FORCE and MOTION
- Generalises over wide range of more specific metaphors (e.g. RELATIONSHIPS ARE A JOURNEY or A CAREER IS A JOURNEY)
- Inheritance hierarchies

Metaphor Example	STATES ARE LOCATIONS (BOUNDED REGIONS IN SPACE) <i>John is in love</i>
Metaphor Example	CHANGE IS MOTION (FROM ONE LOCATION TO ANOTHER) <i>Things went from bad to worse</i>
Metaphor Example	CAUSES ARE FORCES <i>Her argument forced me to change my mind</i>
Metaphor Example	ACTIONS ARE SELF-PROPELLED MOVEMENTS <i>We are moving forward with the new project</i>
Metaphor Example	PURPOSES ARE DESTINATIONS <i>We've finally reached the end of the project</i>
Metaphor Example	MEANS ARE PATHS (TO DESTINATIONS) <i>We completed the project via an unconventional route</i>
Metaphor Example	DIFFICULTIES ARE IMPEDIMENTS TO MOTION <i>It's been uphill all the way on this project</i>

TIME IS SPACE

Time is not conceptualised on its own terms, but rather is conceptualised in significant part metaphorically and metonymically (Lakoff & Johnson 1999: 137)

- Time conceptualised as motion through space
- Primary metaphor – time and motion correlated in experience
- In forward motion, posterior locations associated with past time and anterior locations associated with future time

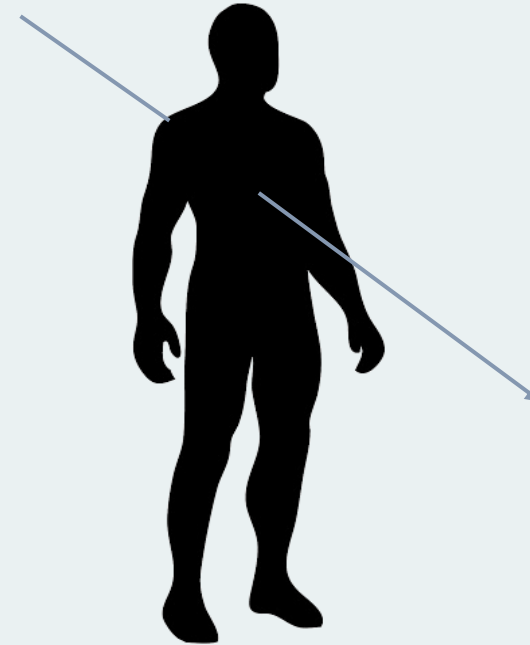


TIME IS SPACE

- Time Orientation metaphor

- a. He has a good future *ahead* of him
- b. In the weeks *ahead* of us
- c. I'm looking *forward* to Christmas
- d. The past is *behind* us now
- e. It's no good looking *backwards*, we must focus on what is *in front* of us now

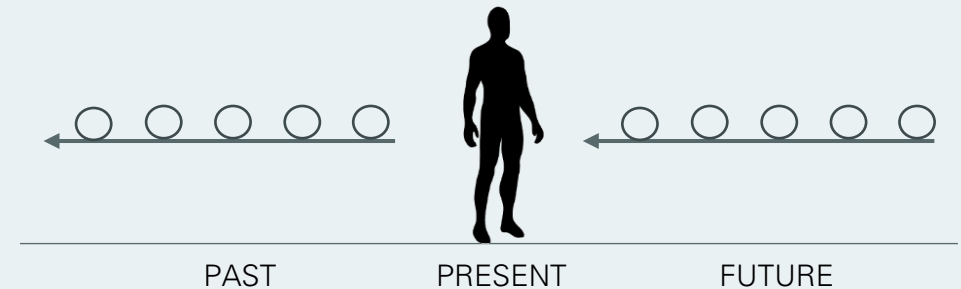
- Not the same across all languages! (e.g. Núñez & Sweetser 2006)



Source domain: SPACE		Target domain: TIME
Observer's location	→	Present
Space in front of observer	→	Future
Space behind observer	→	Past

TIME IS SPACE

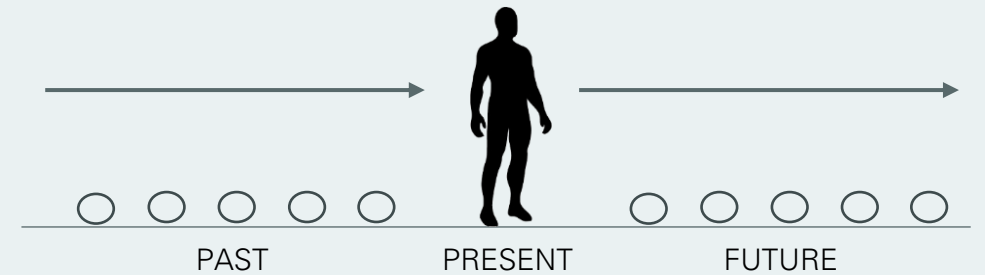
- Moving Time vs. Moving Ego
 - **Moving Time:** Events in time move toward and past observer
 - a. Christmas is *getting closer and closer*
 - b. The time for action has *arrived*
 - c. Those days have long since *passed*



Source domain: SPACE		Target domain: TIME	
Objects	→	Times / Temporal events	
Motion of objects past observer	→	'Passage' of time	
Proximity of objects to observer	→	Imminence of temporal event	

TIME IS SPACE

- Moving Time vs. Moving Ego
 - **Moving Ego:** Observer moves toward and past events in time
 - a. We're *getting closer* to Christmas
 - b. We've *come* to a point in time where action is required
 - c. We've *moved on* since then



Source domain: SPACE		Target domain: TIME	
Locations on observer's path	→	Times / temporal events	
Motion of the observer	→	'Passage' of time	
Distance moved by observer	→	Amount of time 'passed'	
Distance of observer from location	→	Temporal 'distance' of event	
Rapidity of motion of observer	→	Imminence of event's occurrence	

Multimodal Metaphor

- Metaphor primarily a matter of thought and only derivatively of language (Lakoff & Johnson 1980: 153)
- Follows that metaphor “should be capable of assuming non-verbal and multimodal manifestations as well as [...] purely verbal ones” (Forceville 2002: 2)
- Non-verbal and multimodal specimens required to validate claims of CMT
- Found in texts like adverts and cartoons (Forceville 1996; Forceville & Urios-Aparisi 2009)



Thank you

Selected References

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